ULYSSES S. GRANT
TOP 3 LEGENDARY TACTICAL MOVES

Publishing guide: everything you need to upload the finished video



Thumbnail A (UNCONDITIONAL SURRENDER, vidIQ 93). The owner picks the main title and thumbnail; B and C are for Test & compare.

1. The finished video

Item	Details
File	Grant-Top3-1080p.mp4 (1920x1080, 30 fps, H.264 + AAC; -14.3 LUFS, true peak -1.0 dB)
Download	(Gofile link: see chat)
Length	16:14
Voice	Plain Kokoro am_michael narration (owner decision 2026-11-02: keep this voice)
Music	Kevin MacLeod, 4 tracks, CC BY 4.0, ducked under the voice (locked level 0.08)
Sound effects	The channel's locked kit (Freesound CC BY / CC0, Mixkit, original effects)
Flags	US star flag of the date (34 stars to May 1863, 35 stars from June 1863) + Confederate First National; Union blue, Confederates red
Look	Map look v11, no trees, no modern reservoirs, territory colours only on wide overhead shots

Chapters

Starts	Chapter
0:00	Intro: Fort Donelson and the Man Nobody Knew
1:45	Move 1: Fort Henry and Fort Donelson (Feb 1862)
6:04	Move 2: The Vicksburg Campaign (1863)
11:59	Move 3: Across the James River (Jun 1864)
15:06	Legacy

Key frames



2. Titles and thumbnails (Test & compare)

	Title	vidIQ	Claim check (FACT_NOTES, Packaging TEST claims)
A	Ulysses S. Grant's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Accepted Three Confederate Surrenders	87	Donelson garrison 1862, Pemberton 1863, Lee 1865: true (never 'only general in history')
B	Vicksburg: How Grant Cut Loose From His Supply Base and Took the Mississippi	88	'cut loose from my base' = Grant's own words; leaves the locked format
C	Ulysses S. Grant: Fort Donelson, Vicksburg and the Crossing of the James	86	Three places named in the video

The owner picks the main title and main thumbnail; the other two titles and thumbnails go into Test & compare. Judge on CTR and impressions on days 1-3, SEPARATELY from retention at 0:30 and 1:00.









Thumbnails by vidIQ in one go (references: 3 Tactical Genius thumbnails): A UNCONDITIONAL SURRENDER (93, gunboats at a river fort; fits titles A, C), B CUT LOOSE (65, Vicksburg night run; fits title B), C ACROSS THE JAMES (84, pontoon bridge; fits titles A, C). The portrait is an AI-generated generic Union general in colour, not a photograph of Grant; no insignia; face inside the frame; banner spelling checked. The last picture is the 168x94 feed-size strip.

3. Description (copy and paste)

The first line is the title. NO links (channel rule). Keep the credit lines. Fill in the business email.

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Ulysses S. Grant's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Accepted Three Confederate
Surrenders

In February 1862, two rivers ran like open doors into the heart of the Confederacy, and two forts
held them shut. Within a week, more than twelve thousand Confederates had surrendered at Fort
Donelson to a general almost nobody in the North had heard of. It was the first major Union victory
of the war, and it began as a disaster.

In this video we break down Ulysses S. Grant's three greatest tactical moves: the capture of Fort
Henry and Fort Donelson in February 1862, from the gunboats on the Tennessee River to the breakout
on the morning of the fifteenth and the demand for "an unconditional and immediate surrender"; the
Vicksburg campaign of 1863, from the night Porter's gunboats ran the batteries to the decision to
cut loose from his base and the five battles in eighteen days; and the crossing of the James River
in June 1864, when the Army of the Potomac slipped away from Cold Harbor and a pontoon bridge more
than two thousand feet long carried it toward Petersburg. We also look at what went wrong: the
missed chance at Petersburg on 15 June 1864.

Attack while the enemy is still deciding. Go where he says you cannot. Never give him time to catch
his breath.

Which was his greatest move: 1, 2 or 3? Tell us in the comments, and if someone in your family
served in the Civil War, on either side, tell us their story. We read every one.

CHAPTERS
0:00 Intro: Fort Donelson and the Man Nobody Knew
1:45 Move 1: Fort Henry and Fort Donelson (Feb 1862)
6:04 Move 2: The Vicksburg Campaign (1863)
11:59 Move 3: Across the James River (Jun 1864)
15:06 Legacy

SOURCES
Ulysses S. Grant, Personal Memoirs (1885-86)
The War of the Rebellion: Official Records of the Union and Confederate Armies
William T. Sherman, Memoirs (1875)
Alexander K. McClure, Abraham Lincoln and Men of War-Times (1892)
National Park Service battlefield histories (Vicksburg, Petersburg)
Gordon C. Rhea, Cold Harbor: Grant and Lee, May 26-June 3, 1864 (2002), as cited by the National
Park Service

CREDITS
Maps: original animations. Terrain: Mapzen / AWS Terrain Tiles (open data). Rivers traced from USGS
National Hydrography data and the elevation data.

Music by Kevin MacLeod (incompetech.com): "Long Note One", "Wounded", "Long Note Two", "Anguish".
Licensed under Creative Commons: By Attribution 4.0.

Sound effects: "artillery distance" by 2887679652 (CC BY 4.0), "Cannon Artillery distant gunshots"
by Aegersum (CC BY 3.0), "Distant explosion" by juskiddink (CC BY 4.0), "Distant explosions" by
Kostrava (CC0), via freesound.org. Transition sounds: Mixkit (Mixkit Sound Effects Free License).
Other sound effects: original.

Images: Library of Congress prints and photographs (public domain, no known restrictions on
publication); further credits for each file are in the project (CREDITS.md). Flags: drawn from the
historical designs.

Narration voice: AI-generated. Maps and thumbnails: original animations and AI-generated artwork.
Business enquiries: [email to fill in]

#Grant #CivilWar #MilitaryHistory
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4. Upload settings

Setting	Value
Tags	military history, american civil war, Ulysses S. Grant, General Grant, Grant tactics, Fort Donelson, Fort Henry, unconditional surrender, Vicksburg campaign, siege of Vicksburg, Petersburg, crossing of the James River, Cold Harbor, Union army, Army of the Tennessee, Army of the Potomac, animated battle map, greatest military tactics, civil war documentary, civil war animated history
Category	Education
Audience	Not made for kids
Captions	English; auto-caption, then check names (Grant, Donelson, Tilghman, Vicksburg, Bruinsburg, Grierson, Beauregard, Weyanoke, Petersburg)
Altered or synthetic content	Yes: AI narration and AI thumbnails. Tick the box.
Chapters	Automatic from the description (first at 0:00)
Pinned comment	Which was Grant's greatest move: 1, 2 or 3? And if someone in your family served in the Civil War, tell us their story.
End screen	From the channel's busiest video to this one, plus subscribe, over the last ~20 s
Schedule	Your audience's peak time

Upload checklist

- Play the master once (sound, sync, no black frames).
- Upload the master; paste title, description, tags; upload the main thumbnail (1280x720).
- Set up Test & compare with the other titles/thumbnails.
- Tick 'altered or synthetic content'; add end screen; schedule.
- After 24-48 h: log winner, CTR, day 1-3 impressions in research/CHANNEL_LOG.md, separate from retention.

Facts to double-check (grant/research/FACT_NOTES.md, FACTCHECK_A/B/C): troop numbers follow Grant's Memoirs and the Official Records; Vicksburg landing ~17,000 (Wikipedia/NPS), surrender ~29,500; Cold Harbor ~3,500 in under an hour (Rhea via NPS); Lee's wire is the 17 June text. Not used: Shiloh 'Lick em tomorrow', Lincoln's whiskey barrel, McClure's 'I can't spare this man', General Orders No. 11, the pinned name slips, 'Butcher' percentages.